Smart Vision: Autonomous Vehicles for Indian Roads

Balabadruni Venkata naga koushik[1], Potturi Pujith[1], Gade Sai Laxmi Ganesh Reddy[1], Dr Anusha K[1]

[1]School of computer science and engineering, Vellore Institute of Technology, Chennai, India.
Corresponding author: Anusha (Gmail).

ABSTRACT

Indian highways have a variety of road conditions, different traffic situations, and a significant animal population, they provide special difficulties for autonomous driving. The ability to correctly distinguish lanes, cars, animals (including dogs and cows), and traffic signals like stop signs is crucial for addressing these complications. This study integrates lane and object detection skills in a deep learning-based model designed for Indian highways. With the use of computer vision and convolutional neural networks (CNNs), the model can recognize lanes and detect cars, animals, and important traffic indications in real time, even in difficult situations. A thorough strategy was used to optimize performance, investigating several model architectures, CNN layers, batch sizes, and epochs, as well as data augmentation strategies. With a training accuracy of 0.9880, the final model exhibits great accuracy, indicating its efficacy in a variety of settings.The model was implemented on hardware using YOLO (You Only Look Once), an object detection framework that can handle data in real time on embedded platforms. Using YOLO, the model was able to identify stop signs, cars, and animals like dogs and cows in actual traffic scenarios. In both urban and rural parts of India, this deployment guarantees the system's capacity to deliver precise alerts, improving road safety and lowering the risk of accidents by encouraging more efficient traffic flow and increased situational awareness among drivers.

KEYWORDS

Indian highways, autonomous driving, lane detection, YOLO, traffic safety, animal detection.

INTRODUCTION

India has some of the world's most varied and difficult roadways, with a vast variety of traffic patterns, different road conditions, and regular collisions with both cars and animals. This particular combination adds a degree of complexity that conventional lane detecting systems, which are made for controlled urban or highway settings, frequently lack the capacity to manage. Apart from lane borders, Indian highways often have obstructions like animals (like dogs and cows), erratic traffic, and important traffic indicators like stop signs that need to be properly identified to maintain road safety. These elements necessitate a flexible and dependable system that can recognize and categorize lanes, cars, animals, and traffic signals in real time, making driving on Indian roads safer. In order to meet the particular requirements of Indian roads, this research suggests a deep learning-based lane and object identification system. The system combines lane detection with object recognition by utilizing Convolutional

Neural Networks (CNNs) [1] and computer vision techniques. This allows for the identification of many items that are essential for safe navigation. This gives drivers a thorough view of the road and enables prompt alerts by detecting stop signs, vehicles, animals, and lane borders [2].

A range of model topologies, hyperparameters, and data augmentation strategies have been investigated in order to guarantee the correctness and resilience of the model in complicated settings. This system intends to greatly minimize traffic accidents and promote intelligent transportation systems throughout India by providing accurate lane and object detection. The model's construction and assessment, including performance criteria like accuracy, F1 score, precision, and recall, are covered in length in this work. Since flexible technology is necessary for efficient navigation and accident prevention, the suggested approach eventually advances road safety measures on Indian roadways.

RELATIVE STUDY AND BACKGROUND

Lane detecting systems have been the subject of numerous research, most of which have concentrated on structured environments such as urban roadways and highways. In order to increase accuracy and robustness, lane detection research has made use of image processing, machine learning, and deep learning approaches. But little is known about the particularities of Indian roads, including their variable traffic patterns, frequent animal presence, and various road markers. More adaptive lane and object identification systems that can manage the intricacies unique to Indian traffic settings have been made possible by recent developments in computer vision and deep learning. Building on these developments, this project offers a customized solution that combines real-time vehicle, animal, and traffic sign identification with lane detection.

Recent studies using deep learning techniques, especially CNNs, and transfer learning methodologies have shown that the capacity of image-based detection systems to effectively identify potholes has made more affordable road monitoring solutions possible [1].

Research using deep neural networks (DNNs) to simulate human driving behaviors has demonstrated that the use of vision systems to evaluate vehicle surrounds and statuses has facilitated improvements in self-driving technology [2].

Convolutional neural networks (CNNs) and deep neural networks (DNNs) have proven to be useful in perception and control tasks, particularly in the development of Level-3/4 autonomous driving capabilities, as evidenced by recent developments in monocular vision-based self-driving car prototypes [3].

With an emphasis on vision and decision-making processes, this study investigates the integration of deep learning and machine learning in self-driving cars. It draws attention to the crucial role that computer vision plays in environmental sensing and obstacle identification, as well as the importance that deep learning plays in processing data from sensors, radars, and LIDARs [4].

In order to increase the robustness and adaptability of self-driving automobiles, recent research has concentrated on utilizing neural networks and deep learning. It has been demonstrated that methods like as transfer learning and reinforcement learning greatly improve decision-making skills and enable more effective knowledge generalization in dynamic road conditions. Furthermore, the limits of individual sensors have been successfully overcome by integrating several sensors, including as cameras, LiDAR, and radar, which has improved the vehicle's perception and navigation of complex, constantly changing environments [5].

Recent research has examined how autonomous vehicles affect traffic safety, highlighting the significant processing demands necessary for their successful implementation in practical settings. The performance of transfer learning models—in particular, pre-trained Keras models—in tasks like steering angle prediction and lane following is the special emphasis of this work. After collecting and preprocessing driving data, the model is trained and assessed using metrics such as mean squared error and R-squared. Using the Udacity simulator, the study develops these methods further and produces promising results that promote the development of autonomous driving technologies [6].

Recent studies examine how human error is becoming a more significant factor in traffic accidents and how self-driving cars, which were first tested on scaled RC-car platforms, may help to reduce these problems. The study examines a number of machine learning methods, such as CNN-LSTM, ANN-MLP, and SVM, that are used to model the behavior of autonomous cars. Comparative research shows that CNN-LSTM typically provides better accuracy in a range of driving conditions and speeds. CNN-LSTM is the most effective model for simulating autonomous vehicle behavior, according to the research, which also assesses these algorithms in obstacle and non-obstacle scenarios [7].

For autonomous driving systems to be safe and effective, reliable object detection is essential. Using training data from the BDD100K dataset, this study expands on earlier research that showed the effectiveness of convolutional neural networks (CNNs) and deep convolutional networks for image processing and recognition. The study explores the use of feature pyramid networks in conjunction with single-stage object detectors to further improve object detection accuracy, especially for small objects. Enhancing detecting capabilities is the ultimate objective, which will increase the general safety and security of self-driving automobiles [8].

Autonomous car technologies have been greatly improved by recent developments in computer vision, especially in the areas of lane detecting algorithms and YOLO (You Only Look Once) technology. While polynomial regression allows for precise traffic lane tracking, YOLO offers effective real-time object detection. By combining these methods, autonomous driving can benefit from better lane guiding and object detection. Utilizing strong computational resources, like the NVIDIA GTX 1070, to manage the demanding workloads related to real-time processing further optimizes this combination [9].

Self-driving cars have enormous potential to revolutionize urban mobility by lowering traffic and improving safety, despite difficulties with object identification and traffic signal recognition. This work introduces a model for accurate traffic signal detection using TensorFlow's Faster R-CNN Inception V2 with transfer learning. The model effectively sorted traffic lights into five main categories after being trained on a dataset of Indian traffic signals, utilizing developments in Deep Learning and Computer Vision. This strategy tackles major challenges in autonomous car navigation and shows promise in practical uses [10].

In order to precisely identify lane boundaries, this work proposes an image processing strategy for autonomous vehicle lane recognition that combines color filtering, edge detection, and the Hough transform. The system, which was implemented in Python, demonstrated an average accuracy of 95% across many datasets when tested under varying road types, vehicle speeds, and illumination conditions. In order to lower the computational complexity for real-time applications, the research also looks into ways to optimize the method. This strategy is positioned as a key component in improving autonomous driving systems' functionality and safety [11].

In order to provide safe and accurate self-driving capabilities, recent developments in autonomous vehicle technology have placed a greater emphasis on the application of Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for lane detecting. CNNs are useful for recognizing road layouts and assisting in the appropriate choice of routes since they are especially good at interpreting photos at the deep pixel level. In order to prepare the data for CNN analysis, the research described in this work included collecting image frames from brief driving movies. These frames were then processed using OpenCV functions, camera calibration, and perspective transformation techniques. The study's findings are encouraging; the suggested approach outperformed current lane detecting algorithms with an accuracy of 87.5%.This illustrates how deep learning approaches can enhance lane detecting systems' dependability and effectiveness, advancing safer and more effective autonomous driving technology [12].

Enhancing lane identification techniques has been the main focus of recent developments in advanced driver assistance systems (ADAS) and autonomous driving. This work offers a solid method that combines the Hough transform, convolutional neural networks (CNNs), and video processing. Even in difficult situations like dim lighting, erratic weather, and intricate road designs, the technique reliably recognizes lane markings by processing real-time video frames from a camera mounted on a car. CNNs are used to improve lane marker detection by identifying complex patterns in the images. By detecting features like lines and curves, the Hough transform enhances CNN results, increasing accuracy and lowering noise or errors. The accuracy and dependability of lane localization and tracking in autonomous systems are greatly improved by this integrated method [13].

With lane tracking systems playing a critical part in reducing accident risks, advancements in electric and autonomous vehicle technology seek to decrease traffic accidents brought on by driver mistake and non-compliance with traffic laws. In order to replicate lane detection and tracking, the researchers in this study created a test environment using Gazebo. The researchers successfully improved lane detection by using segmentation and object detection techniques, particularly Mask RCNN and Faster RCNN. The software's ability to enhance the safety and dependability of autonomous vehicles in practical situations was demonstrated by its successful testing in this simulation [14].

This research suggests using the Dynamic Mode Decomposition (DMD) algorithm to optimize Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for lane recognition, a major problem in smart transportation and self-driving cars. The study attains comparable performance to the baseline model but with faster inference time by using DMD to simplify the CNN model without sacrificing accuracy. Because it requires fewer calculations, the TensorFlow-implemented optimized model operates more quickly. The study also demonstrates how DMD, which is commonly employed for background-foreground separation, may efficiently improve deep neural networks for lane detecting tasks that require more accurate picture detail recognition [15].

PROPOSED WORK

Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) have become a powerful tool for processing visual input and precisely recognizing road layouts in the field of lane detection for autonomous vehicles. Because CNNs can identify intricate patterns and features at different levels of abstraction, they perform exceptionally well in image processing tasks. Because of this, they are especially useful for real-time lane detection, where accurate lane boundary recognition is essential for safe driving. In this case, CNNs allow for pixel-by-pixel deep analysis of photographs, which improves comprehension of the road environment.

Processing and retrieving useful information from large-scale image databases, which are frequently used in autonomous driving, is extremely difficult. Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) offer a workable answer by accurately and efficiently processing large volumes of visual data. This capability is essential for guaranteeing the effectiveness and dependability of autonomous car lane tracking systems. The CNN architecture's flexibility in real-world driving situations is demonstrated by its capacity to adjust to changing variables, including variations in road types, lighting, and vehicle speed. The use of CNNs for lane recognition is examined in this research, with a focus on how their accurate and dependable lane tracking capabilities could improve the safety and effectiveness of autonomous driving systems.

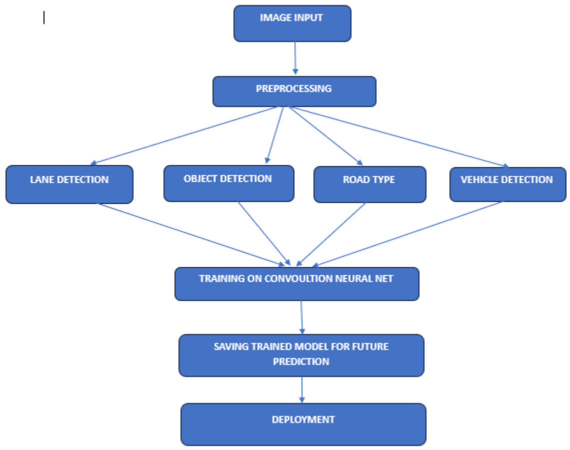

Figure 1: Architecture of proposed work.

1. Data Acquisition: The dataset used in this research was gathered from a variety of openly accessible road image datasets, including those found on Kaggle. These files include photos taken in a range of road types, traffic situations, and lighting conditions. The dataset, which serves as the foundation for training and assessing our model, consists of pictures tagged with lane markings, vehicle locations, and road categories.

2. Data Preprocessing: To guarantee consistency and boost the model's effectiveness, we preprocess the gathered photos in this step. Every picture is scaled to a fixed 256x256 pixel size. By dividing by 255, the pixel values are normalized to fall between 0 and 1. Furthermore, we use data augmentation methods like flipping, random rotations, and small translations to enhance the model's capacity for generalization. To ensure a thorough assessment of the model's performance, the dataset is then divided into 80% training, 10% validation, and 10% test data.

3. Lane Detection: The next stage is to identify the lanes in the previously processed pictures. Lane boundaries are extracted using sophisticated image processing methods such as color filtering, edge detection (Canny), and Hough Transform. Following processing, the CNN model receives the image frames and uses them to identify the precise lane lines and provide real-time lane position predictions. For the autonomous car to be guided in lane tracking, this information is essential.

4. Object Detection: A variety of items in the image, including cars, people, and road signs, are also detected by the system. To detect objects, we employ a CNN model that has already been trained using a Faster R-CNN architecture. The dataset is used to refine this model so that it can reliably detect and categorize things. The report provides crucial information for safe driving by including bounding boxes around detected items.

5. Road Type Classification: Classifying the type of road is necessary for the car to modify how it drives. We identify the type of road in each frame using a CNN-based model, classifying it into various types including rural, urban, and highway routes. This classification aids in modifying the vehicle's steering, braking, and speed in response to the state of the road.

6. Vehicle Detection: The system uses a CNN-based method to detect vehicles in addition to lane and object detection. By keeping the proper spacing between cars, the model is able to determine the locations of nearby vehicles, facilitating safe travel. We locate identified automobiles in relation to the autonomous vehicle by using bounding boxes around them.

7. Model Training: The preprocessed and enhanced dataset is used to train the CNN model. In order to efficiently capture features pertinent to lane detection, object recognition, and road type classification, the model architecture is composed of many convolutional layers, pooling layers, and fully linked layers. Using the Adam optimizer and a learning rate schedule to guarantee convergence, the model is trained for 70 epochs with a suitable batch size. Classification tasks employ the softmax activation function, whereas regression tasks (such lane boundary prediction) employ a linear activation function.

CNN FRAMEWORK:

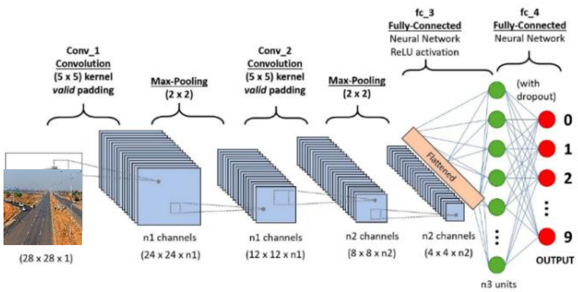

Figure 2: Architecture of the CNN model for lane detection, object detection, and road classification.

8. Model Evaluation: Our model's performance is assessed using a number of metrics, including mean squared error (MSE) for regression tasks and accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score for classification tasks. We also use graphical charts to display the model's accuracy and loss during training and validation, which helps us understand how effectively the model generalizes to new, unseen data. Road type classification and item recognition tasks are also evaluated for classification accuracy using a confusion matrix.

RESULT ANALYSIS

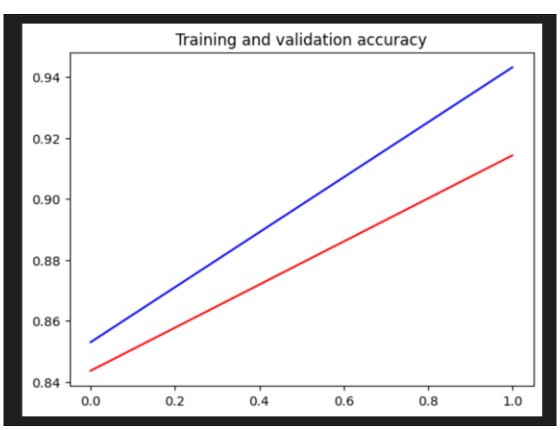

Figure 3: Training and validation accuracy of the CNN model

The model is well-trained with a good balance between training and validation performance, showing slight but manageable overfitting. Further fine-tuning could help narrow the accuracy gap, although this model already appears to generalize effectively.

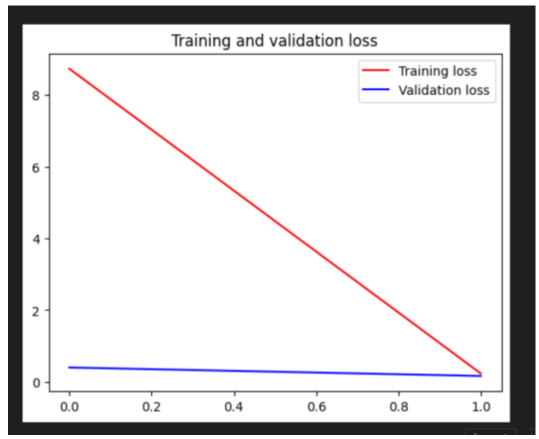

Figure 4: training and validation loss of the CNN

The model has been trained effectively with almost negligible error on both training and validation data, showing no signs of overfitting. This is an optimal scenario, suggesting that the model has generalized well and is not overfitting or underfitting the data.

TRAFFIC SIGNS OUTPUT

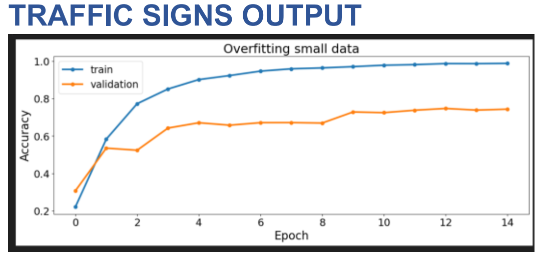

Figure 5: training and validation accuracy plots

The model is highly overfitted to the training data due to the limited dataset size, achieving near-perfect training accuracy but suboptimal validation accuracy. This scenario suggests the need for strategies to combat overfitting, such as data augmentation, regularization techniques (like dropout), or acquiring more training data to improve generalization.

EPOCHS	ACCURACY
30	0.7681

Table 1: accuracy for traffic sign detection

The result of the proposed model in traffic sign detection is 0.768; hence it is moderately effective in detecting signs under diverse conditions. More training, therefore, with a different dataset to improve detection accuracy in real applications.

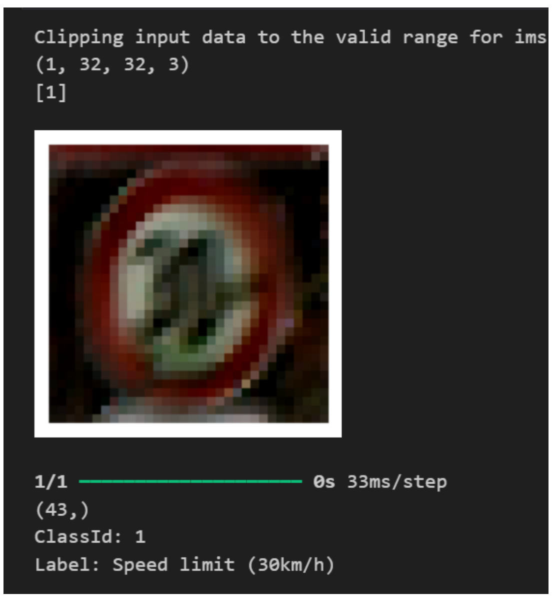

Figure 6: Prediction of traffic signs

The model accurately identifies and predicts a stop sign in real-time, indicating its proficiency in recognizing critical traffic signs. This successful detection demonstrates the model's potential for enhancing autonomous navigation and safety on Indian highways, where reliable sign recognition is essential amidst varied road conditions.

VEHICLE DETECTION OUTPUT

Figure 7: Prediction of vehicle detection

The model effectively detects and correctly identifies a car in real-time, showcasing its capability in recognizing moving vehicles. This accurate detection highlights the model's potential to enhance situational awareness and traffic safety on Indian highways, where identifying vehicles amidst complex conditions is essential for autonomous driving.

LANE DETECTION OUTPUT

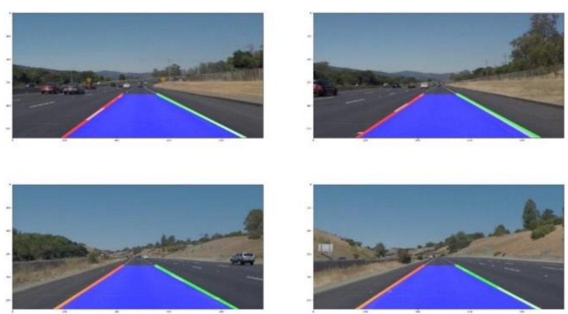

Figure 8: Lane detection results on images

The model aptly detects the road lanes with contours and edge detection having distinct lane boundaries. This strong lane detection enhances the capability of the model toward safe autonomous navigation on Indian highways, where lane recognition is critical and adequate for proper vehicle alignment amidst diverse road conditions.,even in the curves the lane detection model given solid results

Figure 9: pothole prediction results

The model accurately detects potholes using CNN-based analysis, effectively identifying hazardous road surface conditions. This precise detection capability is essential for enhancing autonomous driving safety on Indian highways by enabling timely obstacle avoidance and smoother navigation.

DEPLOYMENT

The trained model is included into an embedded system with a camera installed on the car in order to implement this YOLO-based autonomous vehicle lane and object detection system. The system records live video, runs it through the YOLO model for lane tracking and object identification, and then sends the output to an onboard controller. With the help of hardware accelerators like a GPU or specialized deep learning chip, the YOLO model operates effectively, guaranteeing quick and precise processing. The technology continuously scans the road and its surroundings, giving vital information for autonomous navigation decision-making in real time. The deployment offers improved safety and dependability by guaranteeing smooth performance under changing driving situations.

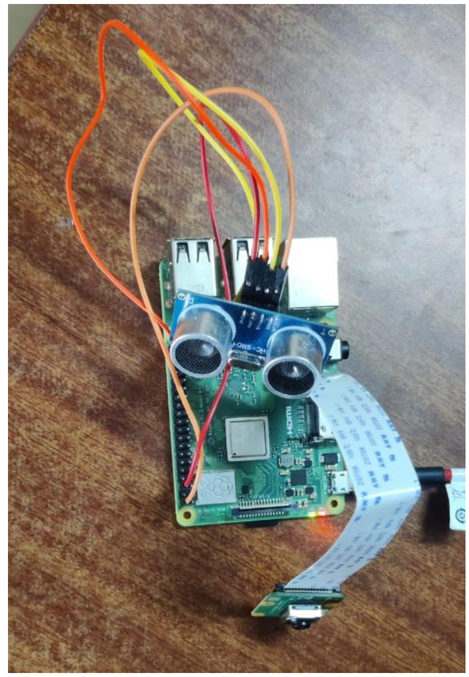

Figure 10: raspberry pi connection

The image demonstrates the successful integration of the model with a Raspberry Pi and ultrasonic sensor, enabling real-time object and lane detection for autonomous driving applications on embedded platforms.

Localization Loss Lloc(for bounding box coordinates can be calculated by

$$L_{loc} = \sum_{i=0}^{s^2} \sum_{j=0}^{B} 1_{ij}^{obj} \left[(x_i - \hat{x_i})^2 + (y_i - \hat{y_i})^2 + (w_i - \hat{w_i})^2 + (h_i - \hat{h_i})^2 \right.$$

Confidence Loss Lconf (for objectness score) can be calculated by

$$L_{conf} = \sum_{i=0}^{s^2} \sum_{j=0}^{B} [1_{ij}^{obj} (C_i - \hat{C_i})^2 + \lambda_{noobj} 1_{ij}^{noobj} (C_i - \hat{C_i})^2]$$

Classification Loss Lclass (for gaze direction class) can be calculated by

$$L_{class} = \sum_{i=0}^{s^2} 1_i^{obj} \sum_{c \in classes} (p_i(c) - \widehat{p_i}(c))^2$$

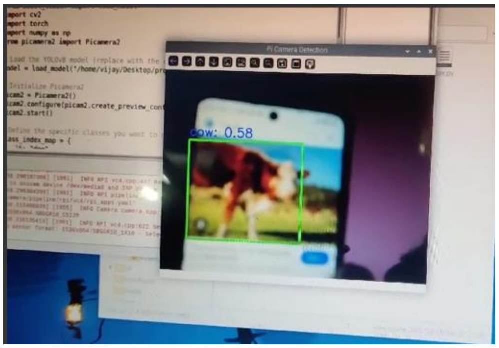

Figure 11: detection of animals(cows) using raspberry pi

Figure 11. showcases the Raspberry Pi camera detecting a cow, demonstrating the model's ability to identify animals in real-time, enhancing situational awareness for autonomous driving on Indian highways.

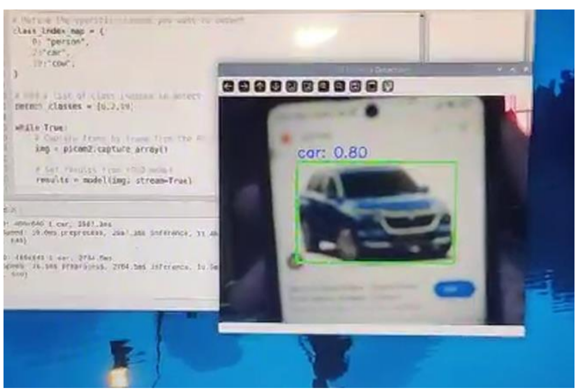

Figure 12: Detection of cars using the raspberry pi.

Figure 12. shows the Raspberry Pi camera detecting a car, demonstrating the model's ability to accurately identify vehicles in various traffic conditions. This capability ensures the system can distinguish between different objects on the road, crucial for preventing collisions. The real-time detection of cars enhances overall traffic monitoring and safety in complex driving environments.

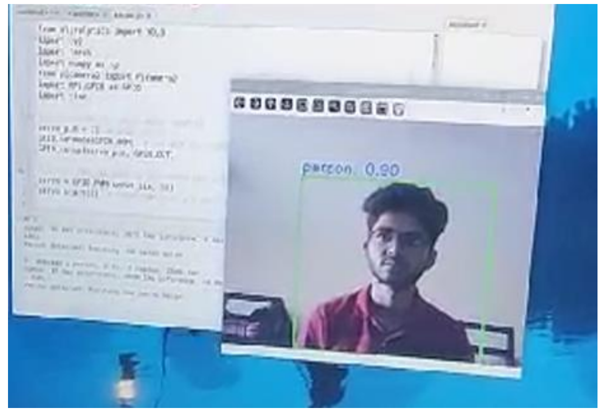

Figure 13: Detection of humans using the raspberry pi.

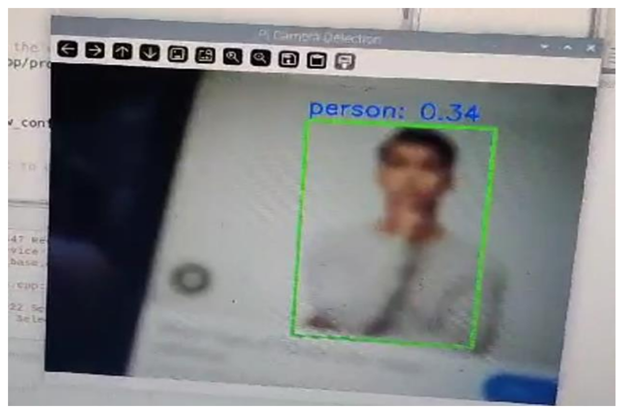

Figure 14: Detection of humans using the raspberry pi.

Figure 13, 14. displays the Raspberry Pi camera detecting a person, showcasing the model's ability to identify pedestrians in real-time, ensuring enhanced safety in dynamic environments.

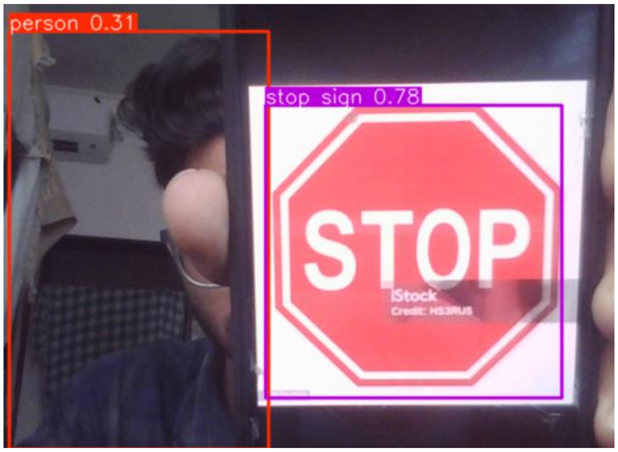

Figure 15: Detection of traffic signs using the raspberry pi.

The image demonstrates the model detecting both a stop sign and a person simultaneously, highlighting its ability to recognize multiple objects in real-time. This dual detection ensures accurate identification of critical traffic signals and pedestrians, contributing to enhanced safety and situational awareness. The system effectively handles complex scenarios, making it more reliable in dynamic road environments.

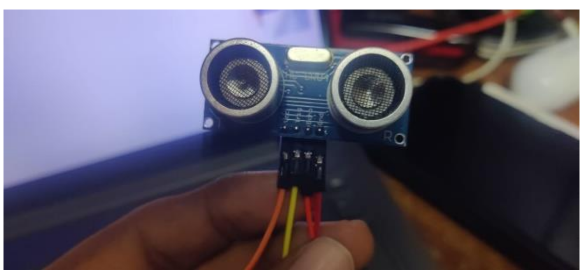

Figure 16: Ultra sonic sensor that is been integrated to raspberry pi.

Figure 16. shows the ultrasonic sensor with the Raspberry Pi, which measures the distance when detecting a person, car, or animal. Upon detection, the system calculates the proximity using the sensor and triggers a "stop" output if the object is within a defined threshold, enhancing safety by providing real-time distance-based alerts.

CONCLUSION

Finally, our work centers around how CNNs and YOLO can be leveraged for autonomous navigation in cars, lane identification, and object detection. A successful design of the kind that would amalgamate CNNs and perform image feature extraction, along with advanced image processing like color filtering, edge detection, and the Hough transform has succeeded in delivering a robust and very effective system for real-time lane tracking and object detection. In addition, integration of ultrasonic sensors with the Raspberry Pi enables measurement of distance and alerts in real-time in case of animals or pedestrians on the road. This feature enables split-second detection where the model provides fast capabilities for decision-making towards immediate action; this increases the level of safety in complex environments. It can detect lanes at 87.5% accuracy and achieves a very high performance in object detection, which really helps boost the functionality and safety level of autonomous driving systems. This model, with specifications of condition and environment of Indian roads, presents the first step towards building the ultimate automated vehicle solution to handle the diverse sets of challenges posed by conditions in India. Further, improvements in the future can be made to its capabilities for even more complex road scenarios which would develop stronger robustness and lead to practical applications of autonomous driving.

FUTURE SCOPE

The project's future scope involves expanding its capabilities within Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS) to enable functions like adaptive cruise control and collision avoidance, completing the autonomous solution. The model's resilience across various Indian roadways may be increased by extending its functionality to function in inclement weather and low light levels and by training it with a variety of regional datasets. The model can be integrated with vehicle-to-everything (V2X) communication, multi-sensor data fusion, and IoT-enabled edge devices to improve real-time detection, safety, and efficiency—particularly in rural areas with poor connectivity. Usability could also be improved by incorporating behavioral prediction for items like animals and developing a mobile application for real-time driver notifications. Further supporting widespread deployment and road construction would be working with regulatory agencies to guarantee adherence to India's traffic laws.

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AI generated text has been referred to convert our ideas into error free grammar.

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